GROUP3

CHPATER 13

WRITING LESS CODE

GROUP3: MEMBER

SIENG LYHENG	E20221090
SOUR ALYA	E20220969
SOPHAT VITOU	E20220813
CHHOUK PHALTHUNIN	E20220467
HOEURN SREYKA	E20220699

INTRODUCTION

"The most readable code is no code at all."

Writing less code does not mean being lazy or avoiding programming. It means solving problems efficiently by writing only the code that is necessary.

- Every additional line of code requires testing, debugging, documentation, and future maintenance.

→ The goal is to keep code simple, readable, lightweight, and easy to maintain.

DON’T BOTHER IMPLEMENTING THAT FEATURE

—YOU WON’T NEED IT

- **Overestimated Value:** Many features go unused and needlessly complicate the application.
- **Hidden Effort:** Quick prototypes mask the true cost of full implementation.
- **Codebase Weight:** Extra features drain time via future maintenance and documentation.

QUESTION AND BREAK DOWN YOUR REQUIREMENTS

- **Not every problem needs a perfect or complex solution. Before coding, first check whether a simpler approach can achieve the same goal.**

Example: Imagine you have 30 stores in Texas, and a customer wants to find the nearest one.

Complex Solution:

The programmer creates a system that:

- Calculates highly accurate distances between the customer and all stores.
- Handles special cases, including stores anywhere in the world.
- Requires more code and testing.

Simple Solution:

The programmer creates a system that:

- Gets the customer's location.
- Compares it with the 30 store locations using a simple distance formula.
- Selects the closest store based on the approximate distance.

DON'T REINVENT THE WHEEL

CUSTOM IMPLEMENTATION

Manual Utility Functions

- ❌ 50+ lines of custom parsing logic
- ❌ Hidden edge cases & memory leaks
- ❌ Requires unique unit test suite

STANDARD LIBRARY
Built-in Modules

- ✅ 1 single clear lubrary call
- ✅ better-tested across thousands of apps
- ✅ Instanttl recgonized by peers

Less Code, Less Debt

01

Remove Dead Code

Deleting code feels like wasted effort. Treat code like creative drafts: writers, artists, and filmmakers don’t keep every draft either.

02

Trust Version Control

Do not comment out old code just to save it. Delete it completely because Git already saved an earlier copy of your file. If you ever need that code again, you can always bring it back from Git's history.

03

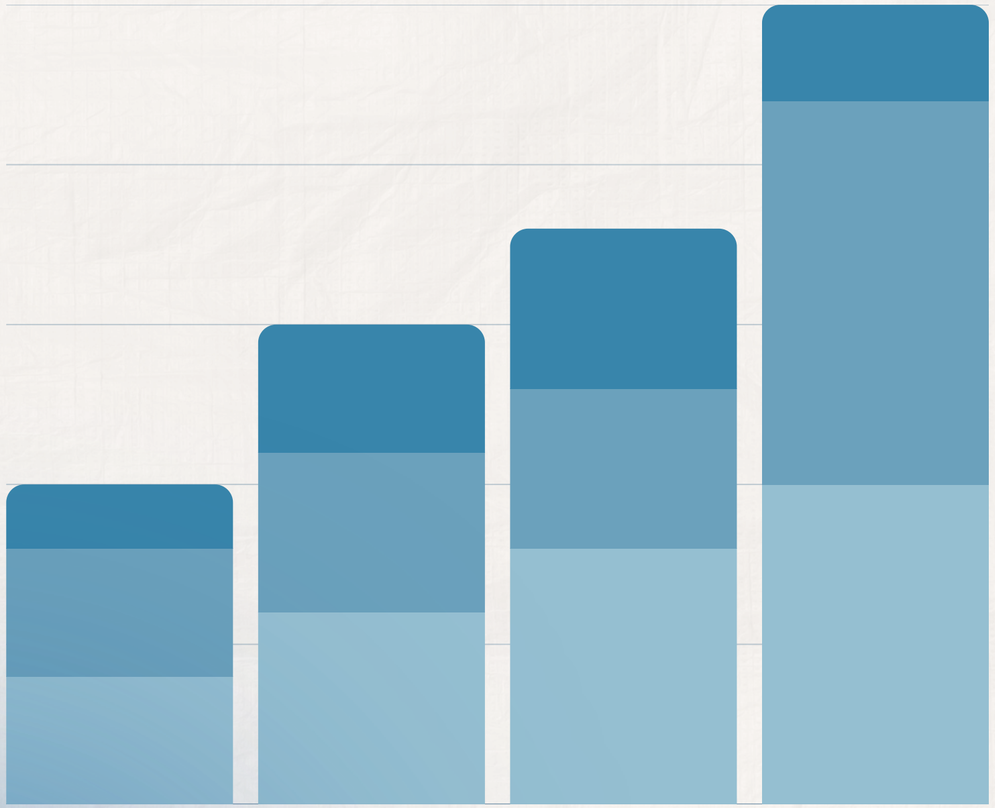
Avoid YAGNI Pitfalls

Find and delete any code nobody uses. Remove dead features to keep your project small and fast.
Less code means fewer bugs and easier updates later.

CONCLUSION

- The most readable code is no code at all: Every line written requires ongoing testing and maintenance.
- Build only what is necessary: Question requirements to solve the simplest version of the problem.
- Prune unused code: Delete dead features to keep the codebase small and easy to navigate.
- Reuse mature tools: Use built-in standard libraries and existing utilities instead of writing custom code from scratch.

THANK YOU
VERY MUCH



COMPETITIVE ANALYSIS

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